Information about the Econometrics master

Daria Ovsyannikova, Ignacio Moreira Lara,
& Christian Wurtz

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First things first: Econometrics info moodle

- Get all important information and updates related to the Econometrics program here



Second things second: Emailing Christian I

- wurtz@statistik.tu-dortmund.de
- Things I can hopefully help you with:
  - Questions about the program structure and course selection
  - Qs about Statistical Theory
  - Qs about other courses I am teaching
  - ... (I'll try my best or at least tell you who can help you instead)
- Things I cannot help you with:
  - Qs about enrollment
  - Qs about visa, accomodation, status as international student in Dortmund
  - Qs about contents of individual courses that I am not teaching
  - For these: try to contact the International Office, or the research assistants of the responsible chairs

Second things second: Emailing Christian II

- If you are in doubt who to contact, you can write to me; **BUT** please try looking for the info / contact person on our website(s) first ☺
- Alternative: study advisory (most likely, it will end up with me anyways...)

Overview of the Master's program

- Structure of the program
- Finding courses
- Completing the course
- Duration and credit requirements

Structure of the program: Conditional admission

- Additional requirements I: Reading course(s)
  - Probability
  - Inference
  - Microeconomics
  - Macroeconomics
- Additional requirements II: Missing credits in economics
  - Not enough econ, but micro & macro
  - Choice of undergrad econ elective course(s)
  - Details here
- Requirements are listed on the admissions offer letter

Structure of the program: The main part

- 120 ECTS required for completion of the program
- 39.5 ECTS in mandatory core modules
  - Statistical theory (13.5 ECTS)
    - ☹ Statistical theory course (9 ECTS)
      - Asymptotic theory (4.5 ECTS)
  - Case studies (8 ECTS)
  - Time series analysis (9 ECTS)
  - Econometric theory (9 ECTS)

Structure of the program: The main part

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  - Case studies (8 ECTS)
  - Time series analysis (9 ECTS)
  - Econometric theory (9 ECTS)
- Three elective sections:
  - Economics (11-26 ECTS)
  - Applied econometrics (11-26 ECTS)
  - Econometric methods (11-26 ECTS)
- Master thesis (30 ECTS)
- Types of courses: lectures and seminars

Finding courses

- Course catalogue (Vorlesungszeichnis)
- Each university has one (click the links):
  - TU Dortmund
  - Ruhr-Universität Bochum
  - Universität Duisburg-Essen
- Moodle rooms:
  - TU Dortmund
  - Ruhr-Universität Bochum
  - Universität Duisburg-Essen
- Econometrics website
- Collection of useful links

Which courses can be taken?

- After finding interesting courses in the catalogues, check the module handbook to see if the course is part of the Econometrics program
  - It is listed: you can take it
  - It is not listed: write to Christian within the deadlines to ask if the course can be added to the program
    - Winter term: before September 15
    - Summer term: before March 15

Do I need to register? I

- Registration to the courses (mostly) not required. Some exceptions: programming courses and lectures offering oral exams
- Seminars and case studies, however, usually require **timely** registration
- Registration might differ from department to department
  - Department of Statistics: fill in survey sent by email once per semester
- Register for the **Moodle room** of each of your courses for material
  - Access key (if required) is given in first lecture and sometimes on the corresponding chair's website or in the course catalogue entry
- Attendance (mostly) not mandatory

Registering for the exam

- You **HAVE** to register for exams
- Registration done in the Campus Portal
- Otherwise, you may contact the Central Examinations Office
- Mr Thomas Bergermann of Team 2 is usually responsible for the Econometrics program
  → pruefungsverwaltung-statistik@tu-dortmund.de

Registering for the exam

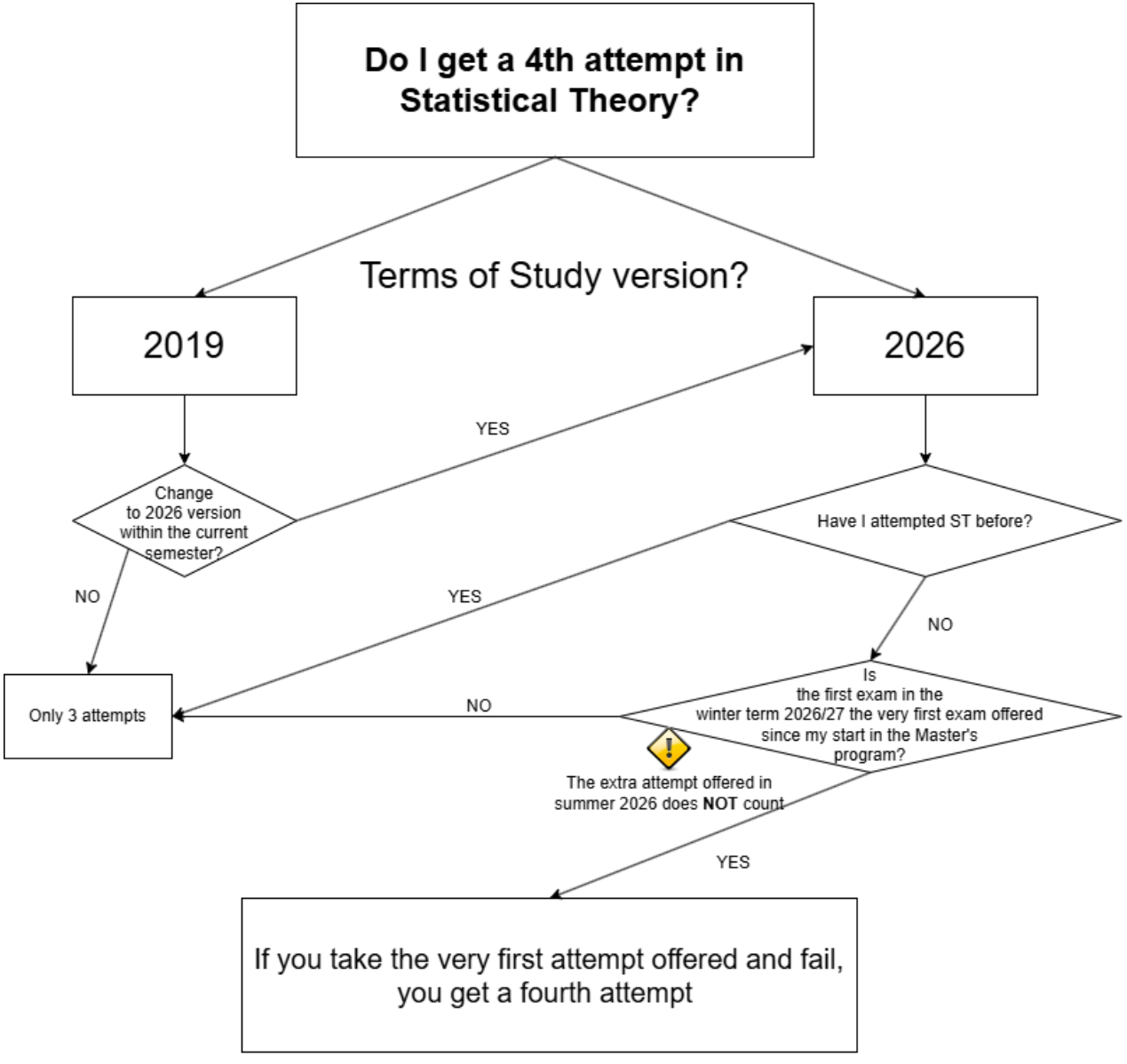
- Registration opens some time in the middle of the semester and can only be done up to two weeks before the exam date
- De-registering is possible up to one day before the exam
- Seminars have particular registration requirements

Statistical theory (☺ or ☹?)

- Take it early rather than late
- You get an extra attempt if you take the very first attempt available to you! Make use of it! ☺
  - ! This applies to PO2026 only
- Go through with the lecture even if you feel sad ☹
- Ask questions as soon as you have them



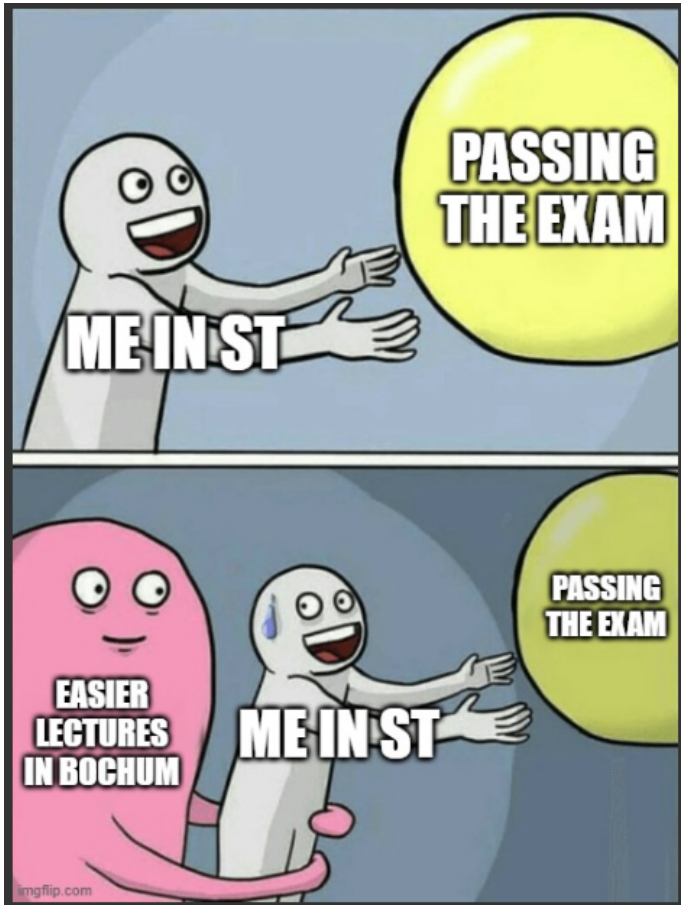
Fourth attempt?



ST

- We recommend going to the tutorial!
- Passing is doable, the 1.0 is something else
- Study **the whole** semester
- Strongly recommend to not take the two first attempts one after the other
- Do the exercises and submit them to get feedback
- Don’t leave it as the last lecture (can’t stress it enough!!!!!!!!!!)

Meme


PASSING THE EXAM
ME IN ST
EASIER LECTURES IN BOCHUM
ME IN ST
PASSING THE EXAM
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Case studies

- Seminar where you work in a group
- Can be quite time-intensive
- You usually need to submit 2-3 reports (everyone individually)
- Every group needs to present at least parts of their reports and results
- Your reports will be graded individually
- The presentation is usually graded for the entire group
- Topic and tasks vary from year to year

Case studies

- Can be substituted with the Data Mining Cup or an external internship
- The Data Mining Cup is potentially less work, but that may depend on your coding skills and previous experience
- Barely anyone has tried the internship option
- As far as we know, the bar is relatively high for the internship to be accepted (so it is not an easy way out)

Tips for case studies

- As with all seminars, register in time (check your emails)
- We recommend taking it in the 2nd or 3rd semester
- Usually, you can choose your group yourself so make sure to find like-minded people to work together with
- You will need to code a bunch in R (not just in case studies) so familiarize yourself with it asap
- Also familiarize yourself with LaTeX since the reports should really be written in it (applies to all scientific works)

Tips for case studies

- The results of the reports are of secondary importance; it is important that your results are reproducible, so focus on:
  - Structure (Introduction, Data, Methods, Results, Conclusion)
  - Grammar and readability
  - References/citations
  - Theoretical/mathematical accuracy
  - Proper figures and tables
- It is tempting to outsource all your work to an AI agent of your choosing, but the professors put bigger emphasis on your **presentations** in times of AI

Master's thesis I

1. Decide whether you want to write an internal or external thesis
2. Find your supervisor and topic (the topics are uploaded on homepages of the professors or here, but it is not a must)
   - If the professor/chair you would like to write your thesis with does not have open topics on their homepage, you can still reach out and ask whether they will supervise your thesis
   - Ideally, you have taken some courses (seminars!) with this professor so you are a bit familiar with the field and the professor has seen you before
3. Find a second supervisor (usually, your first supervisor has some ideas here)

Master's thesis II

4. Once you are ready to register the thesis: write to pruefungsverwaltung-statistik@tu-dortmund.de with your topic and your supervisors
5. In response, you will get a form of Admission to the Master's Thesis Econometrics
   - You have to get the signatures of your two supervisors and from the Chair of the Joint Examination Committee of the Econometrics program (currently: Prof. Demetrescu)
   - Then, you have to send it back to the examinations office **within one week**
6. The official start date is the date on this form

⚠ Disclaimer: This is super important, you won't find this info anywhere. We know it because we suffered.☠

Extracurricular activities

- Fachschaft Statistik: Student Council General Assembly (21.10, 14:15, ME27), Welcome-back party (23.10, 19:00, M.317), board game nights, Werewolf evenings
- Sport on Campus
  - Dortmund
  - Essen
  - Bochum
- Languages on Campus (see here)
- Music on Campus (Website of Uni music)
- Theatre on Campus
- Yearly ”Sommerfest” (summer festival)
- International office

Fachschaft information



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Financing your studies

- Working student positions
- Research and teaching assistant positions
- BAföG
- Scholarship: e.g., Deutschlandstipendium (more info here), DAAD (Scholarship for Special Commitment, etc.), ask chatGPT.

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Thank you and enjoy your studies!